

Volunteering Policy

[A] SCOPE AND PURPOSE

The purpose of volunteering is to offer an incredible opportunity to individuals to contribute towards the betterment of society. A volunteer can give time and skills and experience personal and professional growth.

Volunteers will be at the heart of the Plan India development action future and are vital to our success. We gain enormous value from volunteers, benefitting from a variety of experience and talents to deliver our programs more effectively. Plan India involves volunteers because they –

1. Offer a pool of skills and experience we would not otherwise have access to.
2. Bring extra credibility to our work – volunteers choose us and donate their time and talents freely.
3. Champion our mission and extend our reach in communities.
4. Bring fresh perspective – volunteers are not financially dependent on the organisation so can be better placed than staff to challenge us, guide us, and bring new ideas.
5. Enhance the spirit of Plan India with enthusiasm, passion and commitment.

[B] LEGAL STATUS OF PLAN INDIA VOLUNTEERS

Plan India Volunteers are not staff members. They are subject to neither the Plan India Staff Regulations and Staff Rules nor to the pay, benefits, or other conditions contained therein. They are nevertheless personnel engaged with Plan India and are governed by this document, including any amendments that may result from the revision of the COS in the future.

The terms of service are defined in the Description of Assignment and Plan India Volunteer Contract issued in each case. In all assignments, Plan India Volunteers promote volunteerism through their actions and conduct. The Conditions of Service (COS) form the basis of the policies and rules that regulate the Volunteer assignment. The COS is amended periodically by Plan India. This COS is specific to volunteers and any other policies applicable to Plan India staff or any other personnel, is not applicable to volunteers.

[C] PRIVILEGES

Depending on the entities to which the volunteers are assigned, privileges by the arrangements agreed between these entities and Plan India, which are similar to those granted to Plan India staff. But in conditions, the following conditionality may apply –

1. 2. 3. Volunteers serving with Plan India are afforded privileges in accordance with the prevailing basic agreement with Plan India and serving entities. No special arrangement will be granted or prepared for the volunteering purposes. If so, a pre-approved agreement needs

to be in place.

In case, if the serving entity is a government body or associated government institution, rules and regulations as applicable within that body or associated government institution will be followed.

Mostly Plan India provides a decent working environment and safety standards, but in cases like emergency or extremely remote locations, these standards might not be fulfilled.

Volunteer should understand these challenges and foresee them, before agreeing for the Assignment.

[D] VOLUNTEER ENGAGEMENT

1. 2. Age Consideration: An individual who is above the age of 18 could be a volunteer. An individual who has necessary skills and is qualified to contribute towards the goal. Any person below the age 18, wants to engage with Plan India for the volunteering assignment, should follow the due process and can only be engaged with the written consent of parents/guardians, guaranteeing full responsibility liability and mandatory disclosures.

Recruitment Process: Properly filled volunteer form on website or through link shared and orientation session. Plan India considers diversity and inclusion in the recruitment process.

[E] OPERATION PROTOCOL

1. 2. 3. 4. Roles and responsibility: Volunteers will generally not be engaged for, nor made to perform functions with fiduciary, certifying, approving, supervisory, managerial, representational duty and responsibilities or those normally performed by staff members of the Host Entity. This does not absolutely preclude Volunteers from carrying out task management of capacity development of staff members or hold roles of increased responsibility.

The description of the roles and responsibilities will be illustrated in the volunteer engagement contract or sometimes, is assigned on the specific request of the volunteer or requesting institution.

Any role assigned to the volunteer will have a workplan and associated outcomes, which will be monitored by the reporting manager.

Time Commitment and Scheduling: A Volunteer has to commit specific time commitment whether its specific number of hours per week, weekends or a project-based commitment. Every volunteer will have a time-frame commitment and before agreeing to the volunteer action, it has to be agreed and understood. Time management is the responsibility of the volunteer and not Plan India. Though, we will support the volunteer with her/his time

Supervision and Support: There will be a point of contact or volunteer coordinator who can address volunteer's questions, concerns and provide guidance. Volunteer needs to update about the work-in-progress to the supervisor on a periodic basis.

Recognition and Feedback: A Volunteer will be recognized and appreciated for its efforts,

time commitment by presenting with a certificate, letters of recommendations or organizing appreciation events.

5. Conflict resolution: Create a process for conflict resolution between volunteer, team member or beneficiary

6. Termination and Exit Procedures: If there's any conflict arising with the volunteer and the team for any action, procedure implemented, then it should be brought to knowledge of program head to resolve mutually. Further escalation could be done within Plan India to resolve the issues, as per institutional conflict resolutions mechanisms.

[F] LEGAL AND ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS

1. Safeguarding Code of Conduct: Volunteer has to sign Plan India Safeguarding Policy to keep children and Program participants safe and protected. He has to perform in accordance with

2. 3. Program Head. A volunteer is expected to maintain the respect for beneficiaries and other team members, and adherence to the NGOs values and principles.

Program Guidelines: Plan India has extensive operational guidelines about engagement with the communities, entities and other institutions. Volunteer has to follow these guidelines and practice a professional conduct, while being associated with Plan India.

Plan India Policies: All policies related to ethical conduct will be applied to all the volunteers and they must inform themselves about it and practice it in letter and spirit. Information related to all the effective policies will be provided by the Human Resource & Organizational Development Department to volunteer and a brief orientation will be made to acquaint you from these policies.

[G] PROPRIETARY RIGHTS

All intellectual property and other proprietary rights including, but not limited to, patents, copyrights, and trademarks, with regard to products, processes, inventions, ideas, know-how, or documents and other materials developed in any work performed by a Volunteer as part of his or her official duties shall be vested in the Host Entity. Volunteer will enjoy a perpetual, royalty-free, non-exclusive, and non-transferable license to use all intellectual property or other proprietary rights arising from the Volunteer assignment. Use by the Volunteer of work-related products, including after the Volunteer assignment, is subject to the pre-approval of the Host Entity or Plan India. Misappropriating or withholding intellectual property of Plan India by volunteers may be grounds for disciplinary action and/or further legal action.

[H] UPDATING THE POLICY OVER TIME.

Policy should be regularly reviewed and updated to make sure it remains relevant and effective

[I] COMMUNICATION

Once the policy is finalized, it can be communicated to all existing and prospective volunteers. It should be easily accessible through our website or printed materials.

ABOUT

WHO ARE WE

Plan International (India Chapter), also referred to as Plan India, is an Indian registered not-for-profit organisation that is constantly striving to advance welfare and development for children and equality for all girls and women in India. Through its grassroots social development work, Plan India seeks to create lasting impact in the lives of poor and vulnerable children, their families and communities, by gender transformative child-centered community development.

Since 1996, Plan India has improved the lives of millions of children and young people by enabling them to access and benefit from the safety nets and schemes of the government for child protection, quality education and healthcare services, healthy environment, livelihood opportunities and participation in community development.

PLAN IN INDIA

Plan India initiated its programs in India in 1979. It began its services in need-based and welfare approach only with sponsored children and their families till 1994. Between 1995 to 2003, Plan India began the Integrated Community Development approach to benefit many children beyond the sponsored children. During this period, the programs were designed for individual and community development. In 1996, Plan India was registered as a National Organization.

It has engaged in a big way in the humanitarian sector by responding to the Asian Tsunami in 2005-2006 and released its first report on “State of the Girl Child in India”. From 2005, the Child Centered Community Development approach was practiced by Plan India which put children at the center of all our actions and decision-making processes. This has since continued with Plan India incorporating a gender transformative approach to all its programs.

PLAN INDIA'S COUNTRY STRATEGY

Plan India's Country Strategy V (2022-2027) incorporated the global outcome of Learn, Lead, Decide, and Thrive and focuses on gender-transformative programming

Plan India's Country Strategy V has further enhanced the gender transformative approach with an ambition of "Girls are empowered to take action and get equal". There are six thematic areas that the strategy is designed around.

NATIONAL EVENTS

In addition to the programs, Plan India is instrumental in driving critical conversations on gender through its flagship programs like Plan for Every Child conference, Girls Get Equal campaign, Girl takeovers as part of the International Day of the Girl Child and Literary Festival.

OUR APPROACH

Plan India puts into action the Child Centered Community Development and Gender Transformative approach.

CHILD CENTERED COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

Child-Centred Community Development (CCCD) approach is one in which children, youth, families, and communities are active and leading participants in their development. Plan India describes its way of working in a right-based approach to development, where girls and boys, their specific vulnerabilities, and their rights are the starting point of analysis and discussions. Plan India conducts a Child Rights Situation Analysis before developing its Country Strategy. The voices of Children, Youth, and Families have always formed the base of the strategies developed. In all our work, the most marginalized are given the most attention, taking into consideration the norms, largely gender-based, that contribute to their vulnerability.

Plan India believes that it can't achieve its program vision in silos so that it builds a partnership with CSO networks and collaborates with the government. It prioritized the participation process while working with the community and committed to listening to their point of view, utilizing local and indigenous knowledge and practices. It leads to building their confidence.

GENDER TRANSFORMATIVE APPROACH

There are many forms of inequality and exclusion. Gender-based discrimination, gender stereotyping, and unequal distribution of power between women and men, girls and boys and other genders. Gender inequality intensifies all other forms of exclusion and makes them different and often worse for girls and women.

To address these barriers, Plan India has considered a gender transformative approach, which goes beyond addressing 'symptoms' to explicitly tackling the root causes of gender inequality, particularly unequal gender power relations, discriminatory social norms and systems, structure, policies, and practices.

It improves the daily condition of girls while advancing their position and value in society. The following six quality elements have been integrated with all our work.

1. Understand and address how gender norms influence children through their life course.
2. Build girls' agency over the decisions that affect them and build their knowledge, confidence, skills, and access to and control over resources.
3. Work with and support boys, young men, and men to promote gender equality.
4. Consider girls, boys, young women, and young men in all their diversity.
5. Improve the conditions and social position of girls and young women
6. Create an enabling environment where all stakeholders work together to support children and youth on their journey towards gender equality.

OUR HISTORY

The Plan was founded in 1937 by British journalist John Langdon-Davies and refugee worker Eric Muggerridge. Originally named 'Foster Parents Plan for Children in Spain', the aim was to provide food, accommodation, and education to children whose lives had been disrupted by the Spanish Civil War.

Since that time, their approach to humanitarian assistance has evolved from wartime relief activities to post-war support, to long-term community development and emergency assistance that helps children, their families, and their communities in developing countries.

In 1970, the global name became Plan International and scaled up the program to many developing countries.

FAQs

1. How does Plan make a difference?

Plan's active support for child development over a long period of time aims to improve the healthy development of children from before birth, through safe delivery, preschool care and development, primary and secondary education, to an adulthood in which they can be valuable and productive members of their community.

Plan works to overcome the barriers that prevent children from breaking out of the poverty cycle. Its advocacy initiatives are aligned to child rights as laid down by the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child.

By involving children and seeking their views at every stage of program design, implementation and evaluation, Plan ensures that children play an active role in their own growth.

2. What will Plan do with my Donation?

Plan runs various programs to work with children in difficult circumstances. These programs essentially focus on education, health care, nutrition and protection. Donations received goes towards ensuring that these programs deliver lasting impact in the lives of children, especially girls. In just the last year...

885206 children in the age group of 0-6 yrs, have been reached through early childhood development programs

817621, children and young people have been reached through gender transformative child protection programs

752244 children have accessed quality education

697371 girls and young women have been reached through our programs on sexual reproductive health.

36,652 young people were trained in opportunities that provide employment

1,492,350 people were impacted through our humanitarian response.

3. How do I ensure that my donation for the NGO is utilized properly?

Plan India is well-acknowledged as credible, accountable and transparent organization. It meets all the statutory compliances set forth by the Government of India. Our donor funded projects undergo rigorous third party evaluations and have always been commended on the quality of work and efficiency of processes. To assure complete transparency, our donors/stakeholders are free to check our accounts and/or visit programs. Accounts and programs are audited regularly and strict guidelines on finances are maintained as per Plan International global standards at all times.

4. How much of my money goes towards Plan's development projects?

As a not-for-profit organization that is supported by public funds, Plan India deploys over 80% of the money raised towards program objectives and not more than 20% is earmarked towards administration, marketing and communication. These are well within global and national norms.

5. Does Plan India get funds from any other source than individuals?

In India we have been working on getting funds from corporates and also various funding institutions.

6. How does Plan identify the programs and areas to work in?

Projects are supported based on Plan's identified areas of work and priority needs that align with Plan's vision and mission through thorough need assessment studies.

The projects are identified based on their innovativeness and capacity to change children's lives through involvement of the community members as well as the children themselves.

7. Is my donation tax-exempt?

Yes, all contributions to Plan India are eligible for 50% tax exemption under Section 80(G) of the Income Tax Act.

8. WHO CAN VOLUNTEER?

We accept applications from Indian nationals who are:

- A. Willing to abide by our Safeguarding Children and Young People Policy to protect children from any harm and abuse.
- B. Willing to promote the rights of girls & children to learn, lead , decide & thrive.
- C. Committed to contribute to the community on their own free will without expectations of monetary rewards.
- D. Who have at least basic education till 12th

9. WHO CAN INTERN?

- a. Any student who has a requirement of internship in the course curriculum can apply for Internship along with letter from college
- b. School children above 14 years with consent from parents and accompanied by parents.

10. WHY VOLUNTEER?

- a. To gain a sense of perspective and understand impact of small things on the community.
- b. To make a difference and give back to the society.
- c. To learn and build skills in community development.

11. FOR HOW LONG I CAN VOLUNTEER/INTERN?

- a. Ideally minimum of 15 days and maximum of 6 months or as per project /programme need.
- b. As per Internship letter issued by the respective institute.